Last Updated: September 9, 2026

AYANA NIWA

Ph.D. in Engineering / NLP Researcher

ayana.niwa.28@gmail.com | Abu Dhabi, UAE | ayaniwa.github.io/ | @ayaniwa1213 | ayaniwa

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Project Researcher
National Institute of Informatics | Nov. 2025 – | Tokyo, Japan

Visiting Scientist
RIKEN Center for Advanced Intelligence Project (AIP) | May. 2025 – | Tokyo, Japan

Researcher
MBZUAI | Oct. 2024 – Oct. 2026 | Abu Dhabi, UAE

Research Scientist
Megagon Labs, Recruit Co., Ltd. | Apr. 2023 – Sep. 2024 | Tokyo, Japan

- Job Description: dialogue systems, task ambiguity

Researcher
Tokyo Institute of Technology | June 2023 – Sep. 2024 | Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Prompt optimization, non-autoregressive generation

JSPS Research Fellow (DC2)
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science | Apr. 2021 – Mar. 2023 | Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Structuring templates and acquiring lexical knowledge for text generation

Internship and Outsourced Business
Megagon Labs, Recruit Co., Ltd | June 2019 – Mar. 2023 | Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Sentiment analysis

EDUCATION

Tokyo Institute of Technology
Ph.D. Student in Computer Science

Apr. 2020 – Mar. 2023 | Tokyo, Japan

Tokyo Institute of Technology
M.S. in Computer Science

Apr. 2018 – Mar. 2020 | Tokyo, Japan

Sophia University
B.S. in Science Information

Apr. 2014 – Mar. 2018 | Tokyo, Japan

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Journal

- **A. Niwa**, S. Takase, and N. Okazaki, "Nearest Neighbor Non-autoregressive Text Generation," *Journal of Information Processing*, vol. 31, pp. 344–352, 2023. DOI: 10.2197/ipsjjip.31.344.
- **A. Niwa**, N. Okazaki, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, and M. Mouri, "Construction of a Corpus of Rhetorical Devices in Slogans and Structural Analysis of Antitheses," *ACM Trans. Asian Low-Resour. Lang. Inf. Process.*, vol. 20, no. 6, 2021, ISSN: 2375-4699. DOI: 10.1145/3465218.

International Conferences

- D. Kuzmin, C. J. G. Zavala, M. A. A. Hakim, T. Hiraoka, M. S. Nwadike, **A. Niwa**, M. Cognetta, D. Pohl, and K. Inui, "Mitigating the impact of glitch tokens via targeted retokenization," in *Proceedings of the 5th Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: AACL 2026*, 2026, (to appear).
- R. Koike, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, P. Nakov, and N. Okazaki, "ExaGPT: Example-based machine-generated text detection for human interpretability," in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*, 2026, (to appear).
- M. Ryo, M. Gaku, **A. Niwa**, K. Masahiro, I. Kentaro, M. Terufumi, K. Yuta, and S. Yasuhiro, "Disentangling the effects of unlearning in measuring parametric faithfulness of chain-of-thought," in *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 4: Student Research Workshop)*, San Diego, California, United States: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2026.
- M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, and T. Baldwin, "JailNewsBench: Multi-lingual and regional benchmark for fake news generation under jailbreak attacks," in *The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2026.
- **A. Niwa**, M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, "Rectifying belief space via unlearning to harness LLMs' reasoning," in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025*, W. Che, J. Nabende, E. Shutova, and M. T. Pilehvar, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2025, pp. 25 060–25 075, ISBN: 979-8-89176-256-5. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.findings-acl.1285.
- **A. Niwa** and H. Iso, "AmbigNLG: Addressing task ambiguity in instruction for NLG," in *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, Y. Al-Onaizan, M. Bansal, and Y.-N. Chen, Eds., Miami, Florida, USA: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2024, pp. 10 733–10 752. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2024.emnlp-main.599.
- M. Kaneko, S. Takase, **A. Niwa**, and N. Okazaki, "Interpretability for Language Learners Using Example-Based Grammatical Error Correction," in *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, S. Muresan, P. Nakov, and A. Villavicencio, Eds., Dublin, Ireland: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2022, pp. 7176–7187. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2022.acl-long.496.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, "Predicting Antonyms in Context using BERT," in *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Natural Language Generation*, Aberdeen, Scotland, UK: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2021, pp. 48–54. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2021.inlg-1.6.

Preprint

- **A. Niwa**, M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, *Tracing how language models integrate temporal anchors into factual recall*, 2026. arXiv: 2611.01945 [cs.CL].
- **A. Niwa**, M. Yamada, K. Nakayama, M. Kaneko, H. Suzuki, and S. Sekine, *Rethinking the evaluation of llm fact-checkers*, 2026. arXiv: 2610.30504 [cs.CL].
- T. Shiotani, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, Y. Maruyama, D. Oba, M. Ohi, and N. Okazaki, *Jubaku: An adversarial benchmark for exposing culturally grounded stereotypes in japanese llms*, 2026. arXiv: 2603.20581 [cs.CL].

Article

- **A. Niwa**, S. Yokoi, J. Takayama, and I. Saito. (2024). "NLP Colloquium.," [Online]. Available: https://www.jstage.jst.go.jp/article/jnlp/31/1/31_300/_article/-char/en.

Domestic Conferences and Symposiums

- **A. Niwa**, M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, "Is in-context knowledge integrated consistently into an LLM's belief system?" In *the 32nd Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2026)*, Utsunomiya, Japan, 2026 [**Special Committee Award**].

- R. Miyazato, **A. Niwa**, K. Inui, and K. Harada, "Verification of Temporal Reasoning Abilities of Language Models in Nonlinear Narratives"," in *the 20th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2025 (YANS2025)*, Shizuoka, 2025.
- **A. Niwa**, M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, "Rectifying Belief Space via Unlearning to Harness LLMs' Reasoning," in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, 2025. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_2Win550 [**JSAI Annual Conference Award**].
- R. Koike, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, P. Nakov, and N. Okazaki, "Exagpt: Example-based machine-generated text detection for improving interpretability," in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, vol. JSAI2025, 2025, 3Win589–3Win589. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_3Win589.
- T. Shiotani, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, Y. Maruyama, D. Oba, M. Ohi, and N. Okazaki, "Adversarial benchmark for evaluating stereotypes in japanese culture," in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, vol. JSAI2025, 2025, 3Win512–3Win512. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_3Win512 [**JSAI Annual Conference Award**].
- **A. Niwa** and H. Iso, "Addressing Ambiguity in Instruction for NLG," in *the 30th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2024)*, Hyogo, Japan, 2024 [**Young Researcher's Encouragement Award**].
- **A. Niwa** and N. Okazaki, "Investigating the Effectiveness of Neighbor Distributions in the Pretrained Model T5," in *the 29th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2023)*, Okinawa, Japan, 2023.
- D. Taniguchi, K. Wakimoto, **A. Niwa**, and N. Okazaki, "Testing for Dependence on the Direction of Sentence Generation in Large Language Models," in *the 29th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2023)*, Okinawa, Japan, 2023.
- **A. Niwa**, S. Takase, and N. Okazaki, "Non-autoregressive Generation using the Nearest Neighbor," in *the 28th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2022)*, Online, 2022 [**Special Committee Award**].
- R. Ishikawa, **A. Niwa**, M. Sakae, and N. Okazaki, "Robust Dependency Parsing for the Omission of a Post-positional Particle using Pseudo Training Data," in *the 28th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2022)*, Online, 2022.
- **A. Niwa** and H. Matsuda, "A Study for Sentiment Analysis Accepting the Diverse of Emotion Sensitivities," in *Proceedings of the 35th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2021)*, 2021. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2021.0_2Yin506.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, "Antonym Prediction in Context with BERT," in *the 27th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2021)*, Online, 2021.
- N. Nobori, T. Hiraoka, **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, "Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering Company Information," in *the 27th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2021)*, Online, 2021.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, M. Mouri, and N. Okazaki, "Antithesis structure analysis in slogan using span candidate refinement with word correspondence," in *Proceedings of the 34th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2020)*, 2020. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2020.0_1E5GS901.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, "Slogan Generation with Antitheses Structure with Masked Language Models," in *the 15th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2020 (YANS2020)*, Online, 2020.
- N. Nobori, T. Hiraoka, **A. Niwa**, N. Okazaki, K. Wakimoto, K. Kuroda, and K. Nishiguchi, "Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering company information," in *the 15th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2020 (YANS2020)*, Online, 2020.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, M. Mouri, and N. Okazaki, "Analysis of Antitheses Structure in Advertisement Slogan," in *the 26th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2020)*, Ibaraki, Japan, 2020.
- **A. Niwa**, N. Okazaki, K. Nishiguchi, C. Kameyama, and M. Mouri, "A Study toward Automatic Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering Rhetorical Devices," in *the 14th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2019 (YANS2019)*, Sapporo, Japan, 2019.
- ——, "Analysis for Advertisement Slogan Generation," in *the 25th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2019)*, Nagoya, Japan, 2019.

AWARDS AND HONORS

ACL 2026 Great Reviewer (133/8594)

Jul. 2026 — Website

NLP 2026 Committee Special Award (32/748)

Mar. 2026 — Website

JSAI 2025 Annual Conference Awards (one as first author, one as co-author) (16/513)
Mar. 2025

NLP 2024 Young Researcher's Encouragement Award (18/427)
Mar. 2024 Website

NLP 2022 Committee Special Award (16/365)
Mar. 2022 Website

2021 Microsoft Research Asia Fellowship: Nomination Award (17/157)
Nov. 2021 Website

COMMITTEE

SIG-NL Committee
Apr. 2025 – Website

Editorial Committee
Apr. 2025 – Website

JSAI Planning Committee
May 2024 – Website

INLG2024 Local Organizer
2024 Website

NLP2024 Executive Committee
2024 Website

NLP Colloquium
June 2021 – Website

NLP Study Group for Doctoral Students Organizer
Dec. 2020 – Mar. 2023 Website

Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies (YANS) Commitee
Mar. 2020 – Mar. 2022 Website

INVITED TALKS

Language and AI: The World of NLP Research and Expanding Career Opportunities.
Jun. 2026 Lecture, Keio University

A Quick Overview to Unlock the Potential of LLMs through Prompt Engineering.
Aug. 2024 Advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) by Tokyo AI

The Frontiers of Mathematics, Information, and AI
Nov. 2022 Online Seminar for middle and high-school female students by AIP RIKEN

Career Path as a Female Researcher
Nov. 2021 NeurIPS Meetup Japan 2021, Women in Machine Learning (WiML)

Derivation and Use of Templates in Natural Language Generation
Nov. 2021 Special Interest Group on Fundamental Problems in Artificial Intelligence (SIG-FPAI)

Trends in Natural Language Processing at NeurIPS 2019
Mar. 2020 The 78th AI Seminar: AI Trends and Top Conferences debriefing session (NeurIPS2019) by JSAI

A Smart Computer that Understands Language
Nom. 2019 Jissen Gakuen Senior High School, Tokyo

Natural Language Processing
June 2019 Denenchofu High School, Tokyo

SCHOLARSHIP, FELLOWSHIP, AND GRANTS-IN-AID

Research Fellowship for Young Scientists by Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)
4,800,000 JPY / APPROX 45,000 USD
Apr. 2021 — Mar. 2023

- The most prestigious fellowship for Ph.D. students in Japan [Acceptance Rate < 20%]

Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows: Research Grant (Grant Number: 21J13602)
1,500,000 JPY / APPROX 13,500 USD
Apr. 2021 — Mar. 2023

NeurIPS 2019 Participation Support by the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI)
Full support of travel expense and registration fees
Dec. 2019

Tsubame Scholarship for Doctoral Students by Tokyo Institute of Technology
480,000 JPY / APPROX 4,300 USD
Apr. 2020 — Mar. 2021